Policy Name: Promotional and Marketing Materials Policy
Policy Number: VII. Business Practices 04
Application: All Staff
Date Issued: February 1988
Date Revised: October 2002; May 2020
Effective Date: 05/26/2020
Policy statement: To assure consistent representation of the company in text and images, the Marketing & Communications (MAC) department produces all printed and electronic communications informing internal and external audiences about the Organization. MAC supplies editorial, design and photography services and is the liaison for vendors who provide these services. All Marketing materials must be ordered through the MACConnect Project Request Form, available through the Intranet.

MAC works with internal clients to develop solutions that best meet their marketing goals and budget.

Procedures and Guidelines:

1. Design, Copywriting & Production
    a. Custom projects that require the work of a designer, a copywriter, and external vendors for production require at the minimum 10-15 working days from the start of the design to the delivery of the finished product. More complicated projects with multiple components could take as much as four weeks or longer. Printing times will vary depending on the item and quantity. Projects will not be produced without documented approval from the client via email.
    b. “Direct-to-Print” jobs created using flier templates are paid for by MAC and can only be delivered in black and white (or on colored paper with black ink). They should not require design or copywriting work and should be given two weeks of lead time or

more. MAC also reserves the right to alter any direct-to-print materials that violate brand standards. Please contact MAC if you have a rush request to see if your deadlines are possible.

c. Typical production costs and turnaround times can be found on MACConnect to help with project planning.
d. For promoting most branch-level programs and services, staff should use flier templates available on MACConnect.
e. Staff may not design their own marketing materials or signage from scratch outside of a predesigned template or use outside design programs (for example, Canva).
f. Translations should be coordinated with Language Access Team (LAT). If in-house team cannot complete the translations, MAC or LAT can contract with outside vendors. Translation can add significant time to jobs and a budget code may be required. Please plan accordingly.

2. Printed Materials
    a. Fliers: Simple 8.5” x 11” black and white fliers are paid for by MAC. All other printing orders must include a budget code.
    b. Banners: Outdoor banners should be ordered through MAC, but installation must be coordinated with Maintenance, through a Work Order.
3. Promotional Materials
    a. T-shirts, tote bags and other promotional materials should be given at least one month of lead time. MAC will provide the appropriate logos and artwork. Budget codes must be provided; MAC does not keep an inventory of promotional inventory available for departments to use.
    b. Typical production costs and turnaround times can be found on MACConnect to help with project planning.
4. Larger Projects & Campaigns

a. Projects and events that require various print, digital and promotional materials should be entered using one MACConnect request and must include a budget code. Additional materials can be added to that request via email to the project lead. Please submit these requests at least four weeks prior to the event date to ensure on-time delivery. More time may be required depending on project scope.
b. A “kickoff” email will be sent to those who request materials for larger projects and campaigns, in which schedules, budgets and delivery dates will be discussed and formalized.

5. Digital Displays
    a. Requests for event and program slides for Central and branch digital displays can be made through MACConnect. Programs will be selected for promotion by MAC based on systemwide priorities.
6. Business Cards
    a. Business cards can be ordered via the Business Card Form on MACConnect. Note: Business cards display office/desk phone numbers. For cellular numbers, only company distributed cell phone numbers can be used.
    b. Turnaround times can vary for business cards due to the need to fulfill a printer minimum. Expect delivery in 2-3 weeks after proof approval.
    c. See the Business Card Policy for further information.
7. Advertising
    a. MAC designs advertisements for the company and purchases ad space. Staff may not purchase advertising space on their own or enter into agreements for advertising space even if it is being provided for free. Staff are responsible for providing all funder or sponsor logos and credits to MAC.

b. Staff may not design their own advertisements for media placement; all requests for advertisements must be made through MACConnect and should include a budget code.

8. Press & Media Relations
    a. MAC manages and maintains relationships with the media. Staff may not reach out to or speak with the press on their own.
    b. If staff would like press coverage of an event or service, requests should be made via MACConnect.
    c. See the Media Relations Policy for further information.
9. Social Media
    a. MAC oversees the company's social media presence across all channels. Specific departments may be eligible for their own social accounts.
    b. Staff must obtain permission from MAC before starting a new social media account, and must also develop a management plan and provide all login credentials if the account is approved.
    c. See the Social Media Policy for further information.
10. Website
    a. MAC manages website content and design strategy for the organization. Select staff may have permission to draft and publish new content directly to the website.
    b. Content that does not conform to the current website style guide may be edited or removed by MAC.
    c. Web content should be as evergreen as possible. Timely content may be more suitable for a blog.
    d. Links to external sites are strongly discouraged, as they may become outdated quickly; quality control is difficult to manage over time.
    e. Microsites (websites about programs that are separate from the main website) are not allowed except for special and specific circumstances.

11. Podcasts & Audio
    a. MAC oversees podcast and other audio products. Staff interested in starting a podcast should submit a MACConnect request and first consult with Podcasting Coordinator.
12. Email
    a. MAC oversees all email marketing efforts on behalf of the organization. Staff may not start their own email newsletters and should not use separate email marketing platforms (for example, MailChimp).
    b. Staff should request that a program or service be featured in an email newsletter by submitting a MACConnect request. Programs will be selected based on impact, reach and institutional priorities.
    c. See the Social Media Policy for further information.
13. Signage – Interior
    a. Section signs (horizontal signs over bookshelves) can be printed by MAC at no cost via MACConnect request. Metal section sign holders are ordered through and installed by CPFM.
    b. Endcaps (8.5” x 11” signs on the side of freestanding bookshelves) can be printed by staff from templates found on MACConnect. Endcap holders are ordered through and installed by CPFM.
    c. Larger plastic section signs in some branches with older shelving may need to be specially ordered by MAC and may take extra time to meet printer minimums. Please specify the size of section sign inserts in MACConnect requests.
    d. Shelf clips (small clips that affix to individual bookshelves) are ordered through CPFM. Inserts may be printed by staff from templates found on MACConnect.
14. Signage – Exterior
    a. Each branch has a final signage plan reviewed and approved by the NYC Design Commission and the NYC Landmarks

Commission. Signage will be updated as budget becomes available. CPFM manages rollout plans, budget and installation.

b. Branches located in commercially zoned districts may qualify for an exterior digital sign. Branches in residential zones may not have illuminated signage installed outside.

Issuing Agency: Marketing & Communications
Revision Date: 05/26/2020
Related public documents: MacConnect Project Request Form, Business Card Request Form
Supersedes policy #: Social Media Policy (II. #06), Media Relations Policy (I. #07), Business Card Policy (VII. #01)